



SABLE HARBOR ADVISORY — OPERATING MODEL

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1. Mandate

Sable Harbor Advisory exists to solve consequential client problems and leave behind more capability than it found. It is not a staffing business, a slide-production business, a generic transformation office, or a commercialized version of J2. It combines human judgment, hard operating experience, Atlas Meridian, and problem-specific agent constellations to create measurable interventions and durable client capability.

The commercial promise is:

Bring Sable Harbor a consequential problem. We will establish what is actually happening, determine what can responsibly be known, intervene where we have accepted authority, prove what changed, and transfer the capability the client needs to continue without us.

2. Three practices, one professional bench

2.1 Intelligence Advisory

Client question: *What is actually going on, what should we believe, and what should we do about it?*

Typical matter classes:

- major operating or performance anomalies;
- asset, network, infrastructure or supply-chain intelligence;
- capital and acquisition decision support;
- cross-system investigations;
- complex failure reconstruction;
- decision support under incomplete, contradictory or time-sensitive evidence;
- enterprise risk and dependency investigations;
- strategic industrial intelligence;
- high-consequence diligence where ordinary financial or technical diligence is too narrow.

The practice does not sell omniscience. It makes uncertainty legible and decision-useful.

2.2 Intelligence Capability

Client question: *How do we build an institution that can know what matters before the answer becomes obvious?*

Typical matter classes:

- design of enterprise intelligence functions;

- question and collection architecture;
- accountable problem ownership;
- challenge and dissent mechanisms;
- executive and board orientation;
- institutional memory and provenance;
- investigation workflows;
- evidence and decision records;
- education and professional formation;
- Atlas Meridian implementation for intelligence work;
- operating-model and governance design for intelligence capability.

Sable Harbor may use its own J2 experience as a reference architecture. It does not copy internal J2 structures mechanically into a client or transfer internal J2 records.

2.3 Operational Excellence

Client question: *How do we run this hard physical system materially better?*

Typical matter classes:

- logistics and network optimization;
- mining and processing operations;
- maintenance and reliability;
- reclamation and remediation-function design;
- industrial systems and field operations;
- supply chain and critical-spares performance;
- operating-model redesign;
- process capability and field qualification;
- capital deployment and operating-readiness improvement;
- operational data and decision-flow redesign.

Operational Excellence is staffed heavily from people who have actually operated difficult systems. The practice transfers client-appropriate capability and best practice while protecting Sable Harbor-specific technical methods, recipes, data, trade secrets and operating-business IP.

3. Common bench

The bench is intentionally not a classic consulting pyramid.

Matter teams are assembled from a common pool that may include:

- operating-business veterans;
- former qualifying J2 professionals;
- external domain masters;
- engineers and scientists;
- data and systems specialists;
- product-aware implementation professionals;
- economists and finance professionals;
- human-systems specialists;

- technical builders;
- early-career professionals selected for judgment and learning capacity;
- independent reviewers;
- Atlas Meridian agent constellations.

The firm does not create artificial work solely to keep a leverage pyramid busy. Senior operators and specialists are expected to perform real professional work directly. AI and automation absorb repeatable research, synthesis, production, validation, workflow and coordination tasks where safe and appropriate.

Bench principle

Scarce human judgment should move toward the hardest part of the problem, not toward supervising work that a governed machine can already do.

4. The matter as the unit of production

A **matter** is the smallest accountable commercial unit in Advisory. It has:

- a client;
- a consequential problem;
- a defined scope and authority boundary;
- one Matter Principal;
- an Acceptance Principal;
- a matter-value or acceptance model;
- an Atlas Meridian matter workspace;
- a staffing logic;
- an evidence and provenance model;
- explicit outcome or capability criteria;
- a transfer requirement or explicit managed-service exception;
- closure criteria.

Practices help classify expertise. They do not own the client problem once a matter is formed.

5. Standard matter lifecycle

5.1 Frame

Establish:

- the actual question;
- why it matters;
- who owns the decision;
- what authority Sable Harbor is and is not receiving;
- known constraints;
- value at stake;
- baseline and outcome logic;
- conflicts, legal and security posture;
- initial hypotheses without converting them into desired conclusions.

5.2 Observe

Acquire and organize evidence from systems, documents, people, field conditions and external sources as appropriate. Preserve provenance, gaps, uncertainty, contradictions and access limitations.

5.3 Understand

Build the matter model. Separate observation from inference. Test competing explanations. Identify what would change the team's mind. Use Atlas Meridian to preserve evidence, lineage, models, agent actions, decisions and uncertainty.

5.4 Intervene

Act only within accepted authority. Intervention may mean redesign, implementation, operational change, model change, governance change, system configuration, field experiment, capability build or decision support. Advice without intervention can be valid where intervention belongs to the client.

5.5 Prove

Measure what changed against the pre-agreed baseline and acceptance model. The delivery team does not self-certify variable economics. The Value Office independently verifies governed outcome measures.

5.6 Transfer

Where the matter created enduring capability, transfer:

- client-owned processes;
- roles and decision rights;
- runbooks;
- models;
- evidence and lineage;
- training and formation;
- client-safe Atlas workflows;
- client-specific agents and tests;
- monitoring and acceptance logic;
- ownership and maintenance responsibilities.

5.7 Exit / remain reachable

A clean exit is a success state. Advisory may remain available through Atlas licensing, periodic review, a managed service, or future matters, but it must not manufacture dependency where transfer was promised.

6. AI-native production model

Every suitable matter may instantiate a problem-specific **agent constellation** inside Atlas Meridian.

The constellation is not marketed as a bundle of digital employees. It is an execution architecture composed around the problem.

Possible functions include:

- evidence intake and classification;
- entity resolution;
- temporal reconstruction;
- source-system querying;

- model building;
- scenario generation;
- calculation and reconciliation;
- contradiction detection;
- literature and external-source synthesis;
- workflow execution;
- test generation;
- provenance checking;
- transfer-document generation;
- monitoring after intervention.

Humans remain accountable for professional conclusions, accepted authority, consequential actions, unsafe conditions, client commitments and escalation.

7. Relationship to Atlas Meridian

Atlas Meridian is both:

- a commercial client product; and
- the professional substrate for Advisory work.

For Advisory clients it becomes the coherent digital front door for secure file transfer, evidence, collaboration, matter records, outcome measurement, workflows, agent activity and transfer.

The Atlas product organization builds the system. Advisory uses it. Product developers may support requirements, incidents and controlled design partnerships, but they are not a shadow consulting bench.

8. Relationship to Foundry Field

Foundry Field remains Sable Harbor's flagship deployable operational product and a major source of represented operational terrain.

Advisory may:

- recommend Foundry Field where the client problem requires it;
- use Foundry Field representation as an input to Atlas-driven professional work where licensed and appropriate;
- identify product needs through client work;
- help clients implement and exploit Foundry Field through properly scoped matters.

Foundry Field is not subordinated to Advisory, and Advisory is not merely an implementation wrapper for Foundry Field.

9. Relationship to J2

J2 and Advisory share institutional ancestry but different missions.

J2 serves Sable Harbor's internal intelligence institution. Advisory serves clients.

The boundary is deliberately asymmetric:

- J2 may not be commercially tasked by Advisory.
- Advisory may not recruit serving J2 personnel.
- Former J2 professionals may later join Advisory under explicit rules.
- Client work does not become J2 Canon merely because Sable Harbor learned from it.
- J2 records, protected internal methods and internal access are not client deliverables.

- Advisory may adapt lessons from Sable Harbor's intelligence method without presenting a client implementation as a literal copy of J2.

10. Client promise

Sable Harbor Advisory commits to five professional behaviors:

1. **No purchased conclusions.** The answer may disappoint the client.
2. **No false precision.** Uncertainty travels with the work.
3. **No authority laundering.** A model or consultant cannot manufacture operating authority.
4. **No dependency theater.** What is promised as transferable is actually transferable.
5. **No hidden pyramid.** The client buys the matter outcome and capability, not an incentive to maximize labor consumption.

11. What Advisory does not optimize for

Advisory does not treat the following as primary success measures:

- billable-hour volume;
- utilization maximization;
- junior headcount leverage;
- slide count;
- workshop count;
- token consumption;
- number of agents deployed;
- number of client dependencies created;
- conclusions favorable to the buyer.

It optimizes for professional quality, consequential outcomes, transfer quality, client capability, repeatability where appropriate, economics, trust, and durable reputation.